CLASS 9 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which of the following best captures the irony in the story's reversal of roles? 1

(a) the learner bows to a young teacher **(b)** the teacher is rich
(c) the school is far **(d)** the serial ends

2. 'Her eyes shone like lamps when the first line was read.' This is a: 1

(a) irony **(b)** simile **(c)** oxymoron **(d)** metaphor

3. A reader says, 'Patriotism needs hatred of others.' The poem: 1

(a) supports this **(b)** insults others
(c) does not suggest this; it only praises **(d)** is silent about land

4. The grandmother's tears in the early part are significant because they: 1

(a) show anger at the narrator **(b)** turn helplessness into resolve
(c) end the story **(d)** mock the serial

5. 'Her eyes were lamps of joy.' This is a: 1

(a) simile **(b)** metaphor **(c)** hyperbole **(d)** alliteration

6. Which of the following is a likely objection to calling a land 'peerless'? 1

(a) it is a rhyme **(b)** it is a verb
(c) it may sound like boasting **(d)** it is a number

7. Which inference is best supported by the story? 1

(a) Old people dislike change **(b)** Willpower can outweigh age
(c) Serials should be banned **(d)** Only schools can teach

8. Which sentence is an example of hyperbole? 1

(a) They talked.
(b) She read a book.
(c) I have told you a thousand times to read.
(d) He went home.

9. Read: 'Though her floods are fierce, her rivers feed us.' The sentence presents: 1

(a) a contradiction without meaning **(b)** a balanced view
(c) only blame **(d)** only praise

10. What does the narrator's initial amusement suggest about attitudes to old learners? 1

(a) they are feared **(b)** they are ignored
(c) they are underestimated **(d)** they are admired

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the author make a simple incident universally meaningful? 2

12. How does the old lady in the serial parallel the grandmother's journey? 2

13. What is the difference between patriotism and boasting as seen in the poem? 2

14. 'Learning is a bridge between generations.' How does the story prove this? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically examine: 'The grandmother's courage is greater than the narrator's skill.' 3

16. Does the story suggest society failed the grandmother? Argue. 3

17. Discuss 'Bharat Our Land' as an act of cultural memory. 3

OR

Discuss how the story challenges stereotypes about age and gender. 3

18. Write a complex sentence combining: 'She was old. She worked hard. She succeeded.' 3

OR

How can a poem praising the land also call for responsibility? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'The story is a celebration of lifelong learning.' Discuss with textual support. 5

OR

Critically appreciate 'Bharat Our Land'. 5

20. Analyse the character of the narrator and show how she grows. 5

OR

Examine how Bharati balances beauty and wisdom in praising the land. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND